## Business

1. Meta, the company behind Facebook and Instagram, recently reported its third-quarter results. Despite already being one of the world's most profitable companies, what happened to its profit compared to the same period last year?
   a. It roughly doubled
   b. It more than tripled
   c. It rose by about 50%

2. Barclays recently announced it is cutting 5,000 jobs — around 5% of its 93,000 global staff. The bank's bosses cited one main driver. What was it?
   a. A slump in investment banking revenues
   b. Regulatory pressure to reduce headcount
   c. AI-driven productivity improvements reducing the need for staff

3. Audi, the German luxury carmaker, has just struck a deal that marks a significant first for the brand in North America. The company is investing billions to build a factory in Georgia — its first-ever production plant on US soil. Why is this particularly notable right now?
   a. It follows a Donald Trump tariff regime that makes importing European cars far more expensive
   b. Audi recently lost its manufacturing licence in Germany due to emissions violations
   c. The Georgia plant will exclusively produce electric vehicles for export back to Europe

4. A San Francisco start-up called Marathon Fusion recently claimed to have achieved something that sounds like medieval alchemy. What did it say it had done?
   a. Synthesised diamonds indistinguishable from mined ones at one-tenth the cost
   b. Turned mercury into stable gold at ten times the rate previously achieved by CERN
   c. Extracted gold from seawater using a proprietary filtration membrane

## Economics

5. Eurozone government debt (money owed by European governments, measured as a share of everything their economies produce) recently climbed to 88.8% of GDP. France's debt hit 119.1% of GDP, pushing its borrowing costs above 5%. Which country currently holds the record as the most indebted eurozone member state?
   a. Italy
   b. Greece
   c. Portugal

6. India's government recently announced that from next month, 137 cancer drugs will face government price caps (limits on what companies can charge). The move followed a supreme court case in which a judge described existing mark-ups as 'extortion'. What is the main risk economists flag when governments cap medicine prices?
   a. Pharmaceutical companies may reduce investment in developing new drugs if profits are capped
   b. Cheaper drugs could flood export markets and undercut manufacturers in other countries
   c. Hospitals may stockpile medicines in anticipation of future price rises

7. South Africa and China recently signed a zero-tariff (no import tax) trade deal. In just the four months from May to August, trade between the two countries reached almost $15 billion — up nearly 24% year-on-year. What does South Africa primarily export to China under this arrangement?
   a. Manufactured vehicles and automotive parts
   b. Raw materials including minerals and agricultural goods
   c. Financial and legal services

8. A recent report by KB Financial Group found that South Koreans are sleeping an average of 6.3 hours a night. What share of South Koreans surveyed said they experience persistent fatigue (tiredness that does not go away with rest)?
   a. Around 25%
   b. Around 35%
   c. Almost 50%

## General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of cocoa beans — the raw ingredient in chocolate?
   a. Ghana
   b. Côte d'Ivoire (Ivory Coast)
   c. Brazil

10. Which economist, born in Scotland in 1723, wrote the book now considered the founding text of modern economics — arguing that individual self-interest, guided by market prices, produces outcomes that benefit society as a whole?
   a. David Ricardo
   b. John Stuart Mill
   c. Adam Smith

## Business

1. Meta, the company behind Facebook and Instagram, recently reported its third-quarter results. Despite already being one of the world's most profitable companies, what happened to its profit compared to the same period last year?

*b. Meta's profit more than tripled in Q3 compared to the same quarter a year earlier. The surge came as Meta's heavy investment in AI appears to be paying off — better-targeted ads drove a sharp jump in revenue. It's a remarkable turnaround for a company that posted a rare annual profit decline as recently as 2022.*

2. Barclays recently announced it is cutting 5,000 jobs — around 5% of its 93,000 global staff. The bank's bosses cited one main driver. What was it?

*c. Barclays attributed the cuts to advances in artificial intelligence making some roles redundant. It is part of a broader cost-cutting drive, but AI productivity gains were explicitly cited by senior management. Barclays is far from alone — banks globally are reassessing how many people they need as AI handles more back-office and analytical work.*

3. Audi, the German luxury carmaker, has just struck a deal that marks a significant first for the brand in North America. The company is investing billions to build a factory in Georgia — its first-ever production plant on US soil. Why is this particularly notable right now?

*a. Audi's move comes directly in response to the Trump administration's tariffs on imported vehicles, which have made it significantly more costly to ship cars from Europe to American showrooms. Building locally sidesteps those tariffs. It reflects a wider trend of European and Asian automakers rushing to establish US manufacturing rather than absorb the cost — or pass it on to buyers.*

4. A San Francisco start-up called Marathon Fusion recently claimed to have achieved something that sounds like medieval alchemy. What did it say it had done?

*b. Marathon Fusion claims to have converted mercury into gold — genuine nuclear transmutation — at ten times the rate recorded by CERN, the world's leading particle physics laboratory. If scalable, it raises the same question that synthetic diamonds posed for De Beers: what happens to the price of a precious material when it can be manufactured? Gold markets, understandably, are watching closely.*

## Economics

5. Eurozone government debt (money owed by European governments, measured as a share of everything their economies produce) recently climbed to 88.8% of GDP. France's debt hit 119.1% of GDP, pushing its borrowing costs above 5%. Which country currently holds the record as the most indebted eurozone member state?

*b. Greece remains the most indebted eurozone member, though Italy is now closing in fast. France's position is striking — at 119.1% of GDP, its debt load is enormous for an economy of its size, and borrowing costs topping 5% mean it is paying significantly more to service that debt than it was just a few years ago. Higher rates turn debt from a slow problem into an urgent one.*

6. India's government recently announced that from next month, 137 cancer drugs will face government price caps (limits on what companies can charge). The move followed a supreme court case in which a judge described existing mark-ups as 'extortion'. What is the main risk economists flag when governments cap medicine prices?

*a. Price caps make drugs more affordable now, but risk reducing the financial incentive for companies to develop new treatments in the future — a classic tension between short-term access and long-term innovation. The Indian case is significant: millions of patients currently face financial ruin from cancer diagnoses, so the human cost of inaction is also real. Policymakers are navigating a genuine trade-off, not a simple one.*

7. South Africa and China recently signed a zero-tariff (no import tax) trade deal. In just the four months from May to August, trade between the two countries reached almost $15 billion — up nearly 24% year-on-year. What does South Africa primarily export to China under this arrangement?

*b. South Africa's exports to China are dominated by raw materials — platinum, iron ore, manganese, chrome, and agricultural products such as citrus and wine. China, in turn, exports manufactured goods. The deal fits a familiar pattern in China-Africa trade, where Africa supplies commodities and China supplies consumer and industrial products. The 24% jump shows how quickly tariff removal can shift trade volumes.*

8. A recent report by KB Financial Group found that South Koreans are sleeping an average of 6.3 hours a night. What share of South Koreans surveyed said they experience persistent fatigue (tiredness that does not go away with rest)?

*c. Nearly 50% — specifically 49.9% — of South Koreans reported persistent fatigue despite adequate rest, suggesting the problem goes well beyond simply not sleeping enough. South Korea consistently ranks among the world's most sleep-deprived nations; the OECD has found South Koreans sleep less on average than citizens of almost any other member country. The economic cost of fatigue — lost productivity, higher healthcare use — runs into billions annually.*

## General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of cocoa beans — the raw ingredient in chocolate?

*b. Côte d'Ivoire produces roughly 40–45% of the world's cocoa supply, making it by far the largest single producer. Ghana is second, and together the two West African neighbours account for well over half of global cocoa output. This concentration means that when drought or disease hits the region — as it did severely in 2023–24 — global chocolate prices spike sharply.*

10. Which economist, born in Scotland in 1723, wrote the book now considered the founding text of modern economics — arguing that individual self-interest, guided by market prices, produces outcomes that benefit society as a whole?

*c. Adam Smith published The Wealth of Nations in 1776, the same year as the American Declaration of Independence. His idea that markets coordinate millions of self-interested decisions into broadly beneficial outcomes — what he called the 'invisible hand' — remains one of the most influential concepts in economics. David Ricardo and John Stuart Mill came later and built significantly on Smith's foundations.*